

Safe Product Guide

The 30-second label check, a watch-list, your audit sheet, alternatives, a DIY scrub and a 14-day skin tracker · Module 5, Training 4

The 30-second label check

1. **"Fragrance" / "parfum"** → can legally hide dozens of undisclosed chemicals, often phthalates. Choose *fragrance-free* (not "unscented", which may contain a masking fragrance).
2. **"-paraben"** (methyl-, propyl-, butyl-, ethyl-) → preservatives linked to sperm DNA damage and ovarian-reserve markers (Meeker; Smith, *EHP*).
3. **"phthalate", "DEP", "DBP"** → rarely listed; usually inside "fragrance".
4. **List length** → shorter is usually safer.

Fails on 1–2 items → a candidate for swapping. Skin absorption varies by chemical; parabens and a phthalate applied in a cream were detected in urine within hours (Janjua et al., *ES&T*). Small daily doses on a lot of skin add up.

Watch-list

AVOID OR MINIMISE

fragrance/parfum · parabens · phthalates · triclosan (antibacterial soaps) · oxybenzone (chemical sunscreens) · formaldehyde releasers (DMDM hydantoin, quaternium-15) · "PEG-" with unknown purity · aerosols

ALSO WORTH KNOWING

Databases (e.g. EWG Skin Deep) are a starting point for comparison, not gospel; ratings are conservative and some are debated

Priority order: what's on the most skin for the longest

1. Body lotion · 2. Deodorant (allow two weeks for skin to settle after a switch) · 3. Daily shampoo / body wash · 4. Sunscreen → keep wearing it; choose **mineral** (zinc oxide / titanium dioxide) · 5. Perfume (near-pure fragrance) · 6. Makeup (fragrance-free foundation is easy) · Partners: aftershave, body spray, hair product get the same audit.

Alternatives by category (no brand endorsements; look for fragrance-free and a short list)

CATEGORY	SAFER OPTIONS
Lotion	fragrance-free sensitive-skin lotion · plain shea butter · coconut or jojoba oil
Soap / wash	plain castile soap · fragrance-free bar
Shampoo	fragrance-free; castile diluted works for many
Deodorant	short-list deodorant (magnesium- or baking-soda-based; test for irritation)
Sunscreen	mineral SPF 30+
Toothpaste	fluoride toothpaste with a short list (fluoride is fine)
Perfume	skip, or a single essential-oil-based roll-on used sparingly

DIY cautions: no undiluted essential oils on skin, and none as a cure-all; never make your own sunscreen. Keep DIY to scrubs, oils and castile soap.

DIY BODY SCRUB

½ cup sugar · ¼ cup olive or almond oil · squeeze of lemon or a few drops of vanilla. Stir, jar, use in the shower 1–2× a week.

Ventilation counts too

Sprays, perfumes and scented lotions are inhaled in a small steamy bathroom. Roll-on not spray, cream not mist, window open while you get ready. Hair dye: well-ventilated salon, ammonia-free options, avoid in the first trimester. Nail salons: good ventilation; these are lower priorities than daily lotion.

Audit sheet (40 XP: audit and swap the two highest-contact products)

PRODUCT	FRAGRANCE?	PARABEN?	LONG LIST?	SKIN CONTACT (H/M/L)	SWAP TO	SWAPPED?
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐
						☐

The two I swapped first: 1. _____ 2. _____

14-day skin tracker (30 XP)

DAY	IRRITATION 0–3	DRYNESS 0–3	BREAKOUTS 0–3	NOTES
1				
3				
5				
7				
10				
14				

What changed: _____

Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.